

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 946

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to recognize Father Michael Woods, the 2026 Gala of Lights honoree, for his service to his community and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Father Michael Woods, the honoree at the 2026 Gala of Lights on Saturday, April 25, 2026, in Oak Ridge, who has served the Diocese of Knoxville since 1994 with humility, warmth, and a deep love of community; and

WHEREAS, the Gala of Lights is St. Mary's School's signature fundraising event, bringing together the community to celebrate, support, and shine, while supplying the much-needed revenue necessary for the school to continue to provide exceptional education, rooted in faith, tradition, and academic excellence; and

WHEREAS, ordained in Ireland, Father Michael Woods has been a priest for more than six decades and is known for his distinctive Irish brogue, his heartfelt preaching, and his unwavering commitment to bringing people together in faith; and

WHEREAS, this special event will bring together friends, parishioners, family, and supporters to honor Father Woods's remarkable legacy while celebrating the light he has shared so generously; and

WHEREAS, through his estimable service to his community, Father Michael Woods epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Father Michael Woods for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we specially recognize and congratulate Father Michael Woods of the Diocese of Knoxville on being the honoree at the 2026 Gala of Lights, as we commend his meritorious service to his community and this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.